

Work-Life Balance & Mental Load

Setting limits, easing the mental load

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Setting limits, easing the mental load

Hyperconnection, an endless to-do list, a mental load spilling into your personal life: work-life balance isn't a luxury, it's a condition for lasting health.

This guide helps you understand what stops you from letting go, allow yourself to exist beyond work, and set concrete limits.

Your intention

What spills most from your work life into your personal life: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Why you can't let go

Identity fused with work, fear of disappointing, the belief 'my worth = my productivity': often what stops you from disconnecting comes from further back than your workload.

Understanding it loosens the inner pressure.

Example

Unable to 'switch off', Marc realized he'd proven his worth through work since childhood. It all became clear.

What stops me from letting go

What drives you to never truly disconnect? Where does the pressure come from?

Worth ≠ productivity

Write 3 reasons you have worth that have nothing to do with your productivity.

→ *My worth isn't summed up by my productivity.*

The thoughts that stop you disconnecting

'If I don't reply right away...', 'I must handle everything', the guilt of resting: these thoughts feed hyperconnection and mental load.

Softening them lets you breathe.

Example

Sure 'everything would collapse' if she switched off, Nia tested an evening without email. Nothing collapsed.

Load journal

Note: the thought that stops you disconnecting · a more realistic version.

The guilt of resting

Write why resting isn't 'lazy', but necessary.

→ *Resting isn't laziness — it's a necessity.*

Allowing yourself to exist beyond work

Your needs, your loved ones, your rest, your passions matter as much as your deliverables. A balanced life isn't a brake on your success: it makes it sustainable.

You're far more than your job.

Example

Rediscovering evenings of her own, Léa regained energy... including at work.

My life beyond work

What have you set aside (loved ones, passions, rest) and want to reclaim?

My non-negotiable needs

Write 3 personal needs to protect absolutely (sleep, exercise, time with loved ones...).

→ *I exist well beyond my job.*

Concrete limits

Concretely: set hours and a right to disconnect, prioritize (urgent/important), delegate, say no, and create pro → personal transition rituals.

Mental load eases when you externalize it (lists, sharing tasks).

Example

By cutting notifications after 7pm and sharing the load at home, Sofia got her evenings back.

My limits

Note: my 'disconnect' time · what I delegate · a 'no' to dare.

My transition ritual

What small ritual to mark the end of work (music, a walk, tidying the desk)?

→ *Concrete limits protect my balance.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Set hours and a right to disconnect (notifications off).
- Tell urgent from important; not everything is an emergency.
- Delegate, and learn to say no without over-justifying.
- Create a pro → personal transition ritual, and schedule rest like an appointment.
- Ease the mental load by externalizing it (lists, sharing tasks at home).
- If burnout sets in, see the burnout guide and don't hesitate to seek care.

To fill in

My limits

Area	My concrete limit

My mental load

What weighs on me	How I ease it (delegate/list)

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand what stops me letting go.

Week 2 — Soften the hyperconnection thoughts.

Week 3 — Allow myself a life beyond work.

Week 4 — Set concrete limits.

Your plan in 3 lines

- My disconnect time:
- The 'no' I dare to set:
- My pro→personal transition ritual:

TO CLOSE

Concrete limits protect your balance — and your health.

Concrete limits protect your balance.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.